



3-14-2023 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qCbd1rKnQP8
Publication Date	2023-03-15T11:14:07Z
Target Category	mcs

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Community Meeting Report: Muncie Community Schools Board of Education

Meeting Date: March 21, 2023

Report Prepared By: Expert Civic Analyst

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

The transcript does not indicate any statutory public hearings or committee work sessions held immediately prior to calling the regular meeting to order.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting was called to order by the presiding officer (Board President Mr. Williams), featuring an opening moment of silence and the Pledge of Allegiance led by elementary students.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Dr. O'Neill, Mr. Peter, Dr. Bales, Mrs. Barnes Griffin, Mr. Urban, Mr. Lowe, and Board President Mr. Williams.
 - **Absent:** None noted.

- **Presiding Officer:** Mr. Williams (Board President).
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3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:**
 - Opening moment of silence.
 - Pledge of Allegiance led by fifth-grade students Colton, Raya, and Myla.
 - Introduction of new Assistant Principal at Southview Elementary, Sean Davis [00:02:49](#).
 - Student presentation by East Washington Academy (EWA) fifth graders regarding favorite school memories, upcoming State House trip, and school wishes [00:04:41](#).
 - Administrative update on Southview Elementary building renovations, mid-year reading/writing data growth, and PBIS house system implementation presented by Principal Sarah [00:12:31](#).
 - Human Resources update regarding recruitment and retention strategies, teacher shortages in Indiana, and a new tuition partnership with Marion University presented by Dr. Bell [00:36:23](#).
 - Superintendent update by Dr. K regarding choir achievements, student trips (London, Chicago, Atlanta), and coffee chats [00:43:00](#).
 - **Approval of Minutes:** *Not explicitly detailed or voted upon in the provided transcript text.*
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

[01:09:30](#) Consent Agenda (Items 5.01 to 5.09)

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board President / Administration.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion covered upcoming student field trips, including the ROTC camp, the MCHS HBCU Fair in Chicago (with 11 students signed up), and donor acknowledgments.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

[01:12:14](#) Juul Mass Tort Litigation Settlement

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board Counsel / Administration.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Proposal to join a multi-district mass tort litigation settlement involving Juul e-cigarettes and vape pens, addressing adverse health/safety effects on students and administrative time spent managing vaping issues. Subject to federal district court and special master approval.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

01:13:42 February 2023 Financial Report

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Durham (Chief Financial Officer / Finance).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Review of the February 2023 financial statements. Noted state basic grant receipts (\$3.5M in Feb), payroll of \$2.6M (up \$600k due to headcount and raises), a total checkbook cash balance of \$36.6M, an education fund surplus projection, and a reduction of the \$12M state loan down to \$10.4M.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [01:16:17](#).

01:16:27 YMCA Facility Use Agreement

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Durham / Board Leadership.
- **Deliberation Summary:** A two-year facility use agreement with the YMCA covering the period of their downtown construction and transition. The agreement allows MCS students and families priority use, provides before/after school care, and includes water safety/swimming instruction by the YMCA. Vetted by attorney David day.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:**
 - *Rick Answer* spoke during public forum [01:06:33](#), questioning the YMCA agreement, historical mission changes of the Y, and taxpayers funding recreational facilities.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [01:17:37](#).

01:17:52 2023 Bond Process & Timeline

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Durham / Administration.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Presentation of the 2023 bond project to finish the Muncie Central High School campus and football stadium project (specifically the north locker room and restroom combination building). The bond features a short two-year payback schedule, remaining tax neutral (maintaining a 50-cent debt service rate) due to expiring debt. Includes approval to seek a Construction Manager as Constructor (CMC) and follow the draft publication timeline starting in April.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:**
 - *Rick Answer* commented during public forum [01:05:05](#) noting assurance that the bond will not exceed a couple of years and that overall tax rates have decreased by 7 cents.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Draft timeline and process approved by Voice Vote [01:18:00 / 01:22:23].

01:22:42 Stipend for Highly Effective Teachers at Grissom and Southview Elementary

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. Bell (Human Resources).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Proposal to offer a reoccurring \$5,000 annual monetary stipend (\$2,500 per semester, paid at year-end) to highly effective teachers who voluntarily

transfer or currently work at Grissom Elementary and Southview Elementary, which currently experience lower teacher retention rates (75%<U+2013>89%) compared to other district schools (91%+). Discussion ensued regarding expanding candidate pools, monitoring transfer impacts, and ensuring stop-gaps to avoid unintended internal staffing issues at other schools.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [01:38:31](#).

[01:38:46](#) Teacher Referral Bonus Program

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. Bell (Human Resources).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Proposal to implement a \$500 employee referral bonus for current MCS staff members who actively recruit licensed teachers who are hired, evaluated as highly effective, and complete the 23<U+2013>24 school year at Muncie Community Schools.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [01:43:46](#).

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- [01:04:41](#) **Rick Answer (News man and author):** Addressed the board regarding upcoming action items. Commented positively on the short payback structure and prudence of the new stadium bond, noting local tax rate decreases. Expressed concerns regarding the YMCA facility use agreement, questioning public access equity compared to YMCA member privileges and historical Y missions.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Spring break upcoming next week; various student trips scheduled to London, Chicago (Black College Expo), Atlanta (HBCUs), and Washington D.C.
 - Robotics team competing for Nationals.
 - Ongoing teacher recruitment efforts and upcoming compensation committee meetings in April.
- **Adjournment:** Official motion to adjourn carried by voice vote [01:44:07](#).